

THE BLACK PANTHER

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25¢



"Charges Are A Police Set-Up"

STATEMENT

FROM

HUEY

ALDERMAN LIBRARY

NOV 11 1977

UNIV. OF VIRGINIA
CHARLOTTESVILLE, VA.

"Richmond Incident Has Cast
A Grave Pall On My Hearing"



The following statement by Black Panther Party Founder and President Huey P. Newton was issued on Monday morning, October 31, 1977.

Recognizing the weakness of their case against me, the prosecutor and police have chosen to suggest to the public that I was somehow involved in an assassination attempt against the "chief prosecution witness" on the eve of my initial court hearing. This is false. I cannot and did not condone any action to harm or intimidate any witnesses against me.

In fact, I knew before returning to this country that the prosecution's chief witness, Crystal Grey, had admitted in a taped interview to one of my investigators that:

- She identified me as approaching her in a van "a month or so" after the incident, when it can be proven that I was out of the country at that time.

- She was "loaded," suffered from night-blindness, was nearsighted and not wearing her glasses the night of the incident she allegedly witnessed.

- In her precarious position as a street prostitute, she was subject to police pressure and had substantial involvement with the police, including:

1. She admitted that the police had promised to "set her up" in the Bahamas if she testified against me.

2. She was arrested for a felony before my return and the prosecutor has kept this charge

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Black Panther Party Founder and President HUEY P. NEWTON at court hearing. Chief counsel SHELDON OTIS (rear, right) watches interview.

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